

Novell—And NetWare

Novell Data Systems came into existence as a computer manufacturer and operating system developer. The entire capital of the company was spent in designing hardware, which left no funds for marketing. NetWare was their first proprietary hardware server, based on the Motorola 68000.

In 1982, when the company was running shallow, Raymond J Noorda, who was then a 58-year-old electronics engineer, was quite impressed with their products. Noorda had been with General Electric for about 20 years, and already had turned around other fledgling computer start-ups.

After Noorda became the ninth president, he invested about \$125,000 (Rs 66 lakh today) from his own pocket, borrowed \$1.3 million (Rs 0.7 crore today) from investors, and received a 33 per cent stake in the company. In the early 1980s, Novell rolled out NetWare, the first LAN software based on file server technology. (A file server is a computer that allows storing of files, programs, and resources on its hard drive or other storage medium. It enables the functionality to access files and resources stored on a particular server over the network. So any files and / or resources could be accessed from any computer on the same network.)